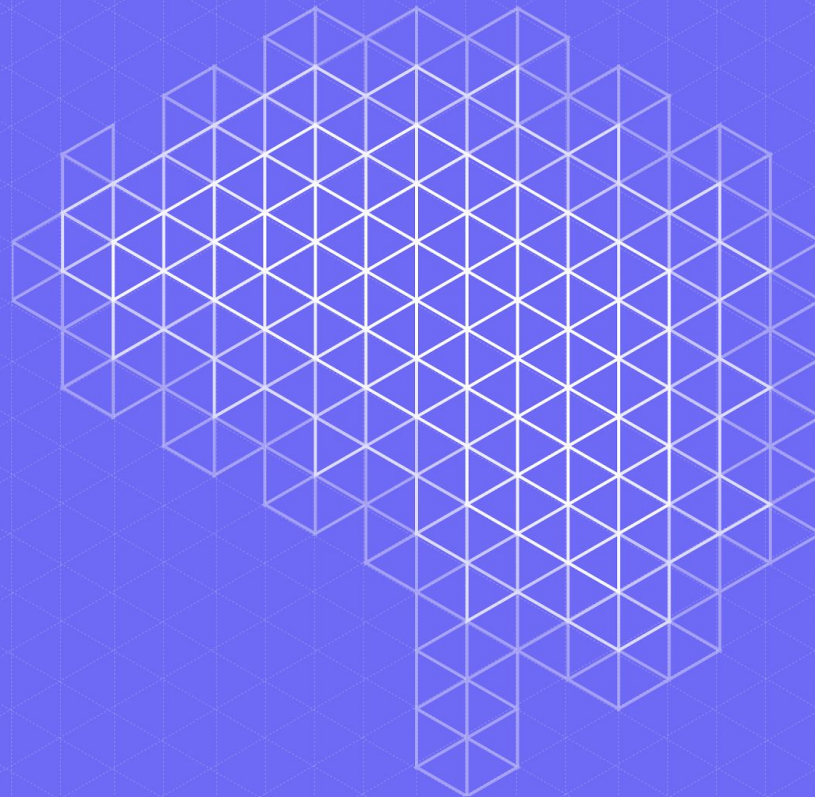




Insights

2025 Feedback from
internal IKE User Testing



Top 5 Usability Problems

Top 5 Usability Problems



Agent Selection Anxiety & Orchestration Confusion

15/16 Users

- 📌 Pain: Unsure which agent to pick, feared making the “wrong” choice, cognitive overload.
- 🧠 Desired: One smart assistant that delegates behind the scenes.



Workspace, Thread, and Source Confusion

14/16 Users

- 📌 Pain: Couldn't understand how workspaces, threads, and sources differ or relate. “What is a workspace supposed to be?” It feels like current workspaces are more projects.
- 🧠 Desired: Clear hierarchy, structure, and onboarding for project organization.



Onboarding Gaps & Cold Start Experience

12/16 Users

- 📌 Pain: Users land on an empty or ambiguous screen with no instructions or orientation
- 🧠 Desired: Users are given a preloaded demo workspace or sample project to explore.

Top 5 Usability Problems



Untitled Threads & Cluttered Nav

08/16 Users



Pain: Threads defaulted to "Untitled," making them hard to find or revisit. Navigation felt cluttered and overwhelming.



Desired: Auto-title threads using the first message or doc; Ability to rename and categorize; Slimmer, focused navigation panel



Upload → Action Disconnect

11/16 Users



Pain: After uploading a document, users had no feedback. They didn't know if it was read, used, or accessible to the agent. This broke trust and flow.



Desired: A prompt to "Chat with this doc"; Clear visual confirmation of doc ingestion; Agent response that references the doc explicitly; wants to upload directly in Chat

Honorable Mentions



Navigation Settings - Workspaces and Agent Switching

📌 Pain: Users were unsure how to switch agents, whether sources applied across workspaces, or why everything looked the same

🧠 Desired: Differentiation or more streamlined agent selection



Power Users - Syntax

📌 Pain: Advanced users requested `/commands`, `@file_refs`, and fast-switching between agents and documents.

🧠 Desired: implement commands for a more intuitive user experience



Redundant Agent Responses or Poor Context Carryover

📌 Pain: Multiple users flagged that agent replies repeated titles, headers, or lacked awareness of previous messages.

🧠 Desired: Improvement on this development

Feedback by Function

Collective Feedback by Function

Function	# of Users	Top Usability Pains	Desired Fixes & Opportunities
Government	4	- Confusion around agent selection (unsure which agent is reading uploaded doc) - Manual document handling - Workspace/thread/source distinction unclear	- Auto-detect relevant agents after upload - Drag-and-drop source upload in chat - Smart workspace guidance
Engineer	3	- Tedious API key setup per agent - Login/auth loops (especially with Okta) - File uploads failed or unclear - Workspace UI not structured for tech users	- Org-level secret key handling - Robust onboarding with guided tour - Upload progress bar - More technical context in agent selection
Marketing	2	- Overload in left nav - Disconnected file upload & chat flow - Weak onboarding - UI too empty or not engaging	- Combine source + agent chat - Add onboarding tooltips - Build demo workspaces - Clarify agent roles with previews
Ops	1	- Workspace vs. thread confusion - Verbose agent responses - Report output dumped into email body without formatting	- Rename "Workspace" to "Project" - Offer summary/tables - Export as PDF/Word with comment box
Product	2	- Agent selection unclear (by function or tool?) - Workspace duplication allowed - Source upload disconnected from agent context	- Smart default agent routing - Prevent duplicate workspace names - Visual cues that show when an agent "read" a file
Sales/CX	2	- Thread titles like "Untitled" - Homepage not helpful (cold start) - Friction in uploading and navigating docs - Source usage unclear in responses	- Auto-title threads based on prompt - Default to chat view on load - "Chat with this doc" button post-upload
Finance	1	- Okta login issues - No memory across sessions - Manual file uploads (hundreds of contracts)	- Persistent login + memory - GDrive integration for batch ingest - Smart onboarding
Knowledge	1	- Upload failures (10+ tries) - Agent not labeled in response - File organization missing filters or folders	- Background upload with progress bar - Show "Data Agent" label per reply - Add sorting/filters in Source tab

Tech Stack + Agent Usage by Function

Function	# of Users	Tech Stack	Agents Used
Government	4	- DocuSign, Google Drive for contract storage - Confluence/SharePoint for policy docs	- Librarian, Research Agent Needed contextual understanding of docs and trust in source mapping
Engineer	3	- Postman, Swagger, Jira, Slack - Okta for SSO - Command-line workflows	- Data Agent (for CSVs) Avoided agents that felt “too abstract” or “not programmatic”
Marketing	2	- Google Slides, Decks, PDFs, Figma, Slack	- Research Agent, sometimes Support Agent; Wanted summarization + formatted outputs
Ops	1	- Excel, Slack, Airtable - Email reports from systems	- Support Agent, Compliance Agent Wanted clean reports and summaries
Product	2	- Jira, Notion, Slack - Google Docs for PRDs - Engineering handoff workflows	- Research Agent, some tried Librarian Wanted “triage” or orchestration layer
Sales/CX	2	- Gong, Salesforce, Google Docs - Slack	- Support Agent, sometimes misused Data Agent Expected call recaps and client-ready summaries
Finance	1	- Confluence, Excel, Google Drive - RFPs, pricing docs	- Compliance Agent, Research Agent Wanted trustable sourcing and short exports
Knowledge	1	- Google Drive, Confluence, PDF repositories	- Librarian, Data Agent Wanted search, doc recall, and filtering in Sources tab

User Stories

User	Function	User Story
Zachary Smith	Government	As a power-user, I want to rely on agents to monitor, delegate, and decide, so that I can operate more strategically without being in the weeds every day.
Rodrigo Velasquez	Engineer	As a power user of AI agents, I want to configure multiple agents with clean workstreams and rich memory, so that I can replace my manual reporting workflows and scale executive comms.
Marc Johnson	Marketing	As a technical operations leader, I want to deploy agent teams with persistent memory and permissions, so that I can delegate cross-functional work and remove myself as a bottleneck.
Dan Michelle	Ops	As a strategic operations leader, I want to interact with one smart, generalist agent that can route tasks and retrieve the right data, so that I can build reports, prioritize work, and manage cross-functional initiatives without switching tools or selecting specific agents.
Dennis Yuscavitch	Marketing	As a C-suite strategist, I want to query across my team's documents and Slack with a single agent, so that I can uncover insights and prioritize action during busy weeks.
Megan Thatford	Government	As a marketing and content leader, I want to trust that the agent accurately references source materials, so that I can use its outputs directly in client-facing messaging without heavy edits.
Tom Plant	Product	As a product manager with many roles, I want to upload decks, ask questions, and get smart summaries quickly, so that I can make better decisions across product, sales, and ops.
Ash Mallik	Engineer	As a developer-leaning user, I want to build and chain agents that reflect real workflows, so that I can automate my startup's daily ops and scale faster.

User Stories

User	Function	User Story
Matt Hong	Engineer	As a user, I want to interact with IKE using simple dropdowns and clean outputs, so that I can scan, share, and trust the work it's doing without the clutter
Alex Merrill	Product	As a strategic executive, I want to feel like IKE knows me and my priorities, so that I can trust it to help run my team like a co-pilot — not start from scratch every time.
Ken Fried	Sales / CX	As a fast-paced revenue leader, I want to drop in docs, ask pointed questions, and get tight answers, so that I can move faster across calls, decks, and pitches with minimal context switching.
Jason V	Sales / CX	As a sales / CX support, I want to treat agents like projects with clear goals, so that I can use them for real deliverables like decks and reports, not just chat.
Jaime Rao	Finance	As a finance team member, I want to use IKE to rapidly review agreements and financial docs, so that I can prep for investor calls and reporting cycles more efficiently.
Brian Drake	Government	As a senior leader in business ops, I want to upload large doc sets and get action plans, so that I can make better strategic decisions without reading everything myself.
Kim DeLeon	Government	As a business development lead in GovTech, I want to use IKE to coordinate proposal agents and pull knowledge from Confluence and Salesforce, so that I can accelerate our pipeline and scale our response process.
Jason Newman + AIP	Knowledge	As a knowledge strategy group, We want to use IKE to power our benchmarking and internal doc analysis, so that we can share clean, consistent knowledge across org functions.

Feedback by Feature

Navigation



App logo as a navigation element

- 📌 Pain: Users expected the logo to take them “home”; No hover state or tooltip – didn’t feel interactive
- 🧠 Desired: Make logo clickable → route to personal workspace or dashboard; Add hover state, tooltip, and pointer cursor; Context-aware routing (e.g., “Back to Workspace” from chat)



Landing Screen / Cold Start

- 📌 Pain: Users didn’t know what to do next; Confusing if they landed in a shared vs personal workspace
- 🧠 Desired: Default to personal space or “last opened”; Add onboarding checklist or “get started” overlay; Show recent threads or most active workspace



Left-Hand Panel (Thread Titles)

- 📌 Pain: Users couldn’t tell what was a thread vs workspace; “Untitled” cluttered panel; Difficult to find active thread
- 🧠 Desired: Consistent icons for thread types; Drag-and-drop for organizing; Rename options for clarity

Navigation



Agents – Invocation (@ / Dropdown)



“@” syntax felt awkward; Agent selection felt like cognitive load; Users didn’t know what each agent did



Desired: Triage agent to handle orchestration; Hover previews to explain agent capabilities; Allow natural language invocation: “Use the data agent for this”



Agents – Switching



Pain: Unclear if context is preserved; No visible “handoff” option



Desired: Add “Switch and continue” function; Let triage recommend an agent; Visually show active agent and context status

Workspace + Landing Page



Workspace – Naming & Creation



“Workspace” label felt abstract; Users unsure what they were naming



Desired: Rename “Workspace” to “Project” or offer renaming; Add tooltips with examples; Suggest names based on recent tasks



Workspace – Landing Page Layout



Pain: Sparse UI felt empty or unclear; Welcome message not helpful; No clear next step



Desired: Replace welcome with recent activity or checklist; Show demo workspace or walkthrough; Greet user with helper agent on first use



Workspace – Shared vs Personal Sorting



Pain: Shared workspaces were shown first by default; No way to toggle or filter view



Desired: Default to personal view; Add “All / Personal / Shared” toggle; Use icons to distinguish workspace types

Sources



Sources – Uploading

- 📌 Pain: Upload not available in chat; Manual upload disrupted flow; No confirmation or feedback
- 🧠 Desired: Enable drag-and-drop in chat view; GDrive or Dropbox sync; Show upload progress and confirmation



Sources – Librarian Agent

- 📌 Pain: “Librarian” name unclear; Users confused between Librarian and Web Search; Output reliability mixed
- 🧠 Desired: Rename to “Document Search”; Combine with Web Search in one smart agent; Use icons or previews for clarity



Sources – Query Scope

- 📌 Pain: Unclear if agent used uploaded sources; No way to restrict source scope
- 🧠 Desired: Add attribution (e.g., “Source: advisor_policies.pdf”); Query filter: “Only use uploaded docs”; Pin documents for priority reference

Sources



Sources – Thumbnail vs List View



List view: too compressed; Thumbnail: poor for text-based docs; No quick doc insights



Desired: Let users choose default view; Show metadata (filename, type, upload date); Add hover previews; Overlay file names in thumbnail view; Quick actions (preview, delete, analyze)

Scoring + Dark / Light Mode



Light + Dark Mode Preferences

Overall Preference (Feature easy to navigate) : 

Zachary Smith



Rodrigo Velasquez



Marc Johnson

N / A

Dan Michelle



Dennis Yuscavitch



Megan Thatford



Tom Plant

N / A

Ash Mallik



Matt Hong



Alex Merrill



Ken Fried



Jason V



Jaime Rao



Brian Drake



Kim DeLeon



Jason Newman + AIP

N / A

User Scores

User	Onboarding Scale	Usability Scale	Applicability Scale
Zachary Smith	★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★★
Rodrigo Velasquez	★★★★	★★★★	★★
Marc Johnson	★★	★★★★	★★★★
Dan Michelle	★	★★★★	★★
Dennis Yuscavitch	★★★★★	★★★★	★
Megan Thatford	★★★★	★★★.5	★★★-★
Tom Plant	★★★★★★	★★★★	★★★★★★
Ash Mallik	★★★★	★★★★★★	★★

User Scores

User	Onboarding Scale	Usability Scale	Applicability Scale
Matt Hong	N / A	★★★★-★	★★-★
Alex Merrill	★★★★★★	★★	★
Ken Fried	★★★★	★★★★	★★★★
Jason V	★★★★.5	★★★★★	★★★★★
Jaime Rao	★★	★★★★★	★★-★
Brian Drake	★	★★★★	★
Kim DeLeon	★★	★★★★★	★★
Jason Newman + AIP	★★-★	★★★★★	★★★★

At Accrete AI, we're pioneering AI technology for social intelligence, empowering you with actionable insights to stay ahead of the curve.

thank you